The scanner’s data pipeline

How a screener tool finds a stock, where every piece of information about it comes from, how it is processed, and how it ends up on a **card** and in the **registers**. Written from the code (`src/pipeline.js` and the `side*` folders it calls); every endpoint, threshold and field name below is the one the code uses.

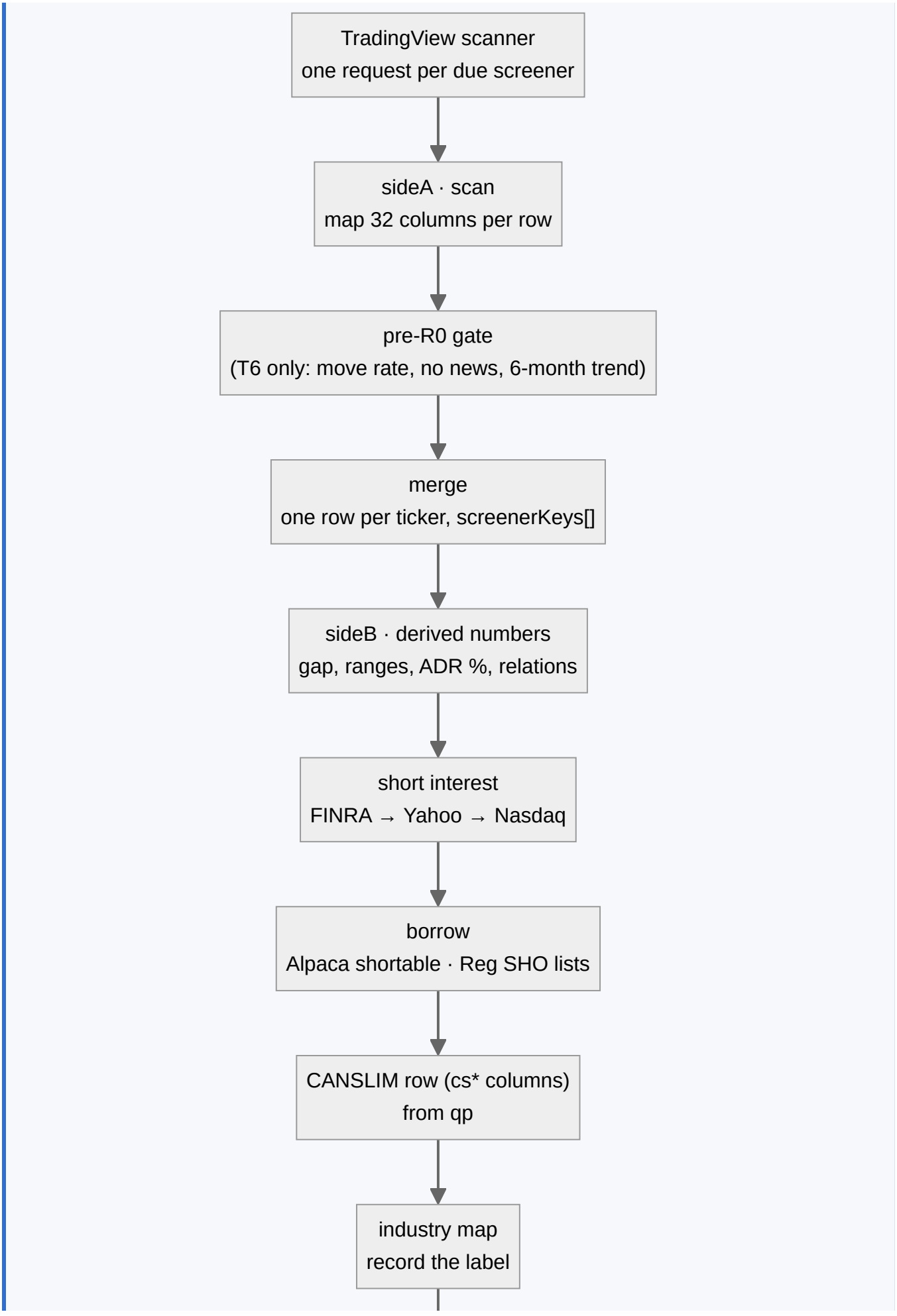
Related documents:

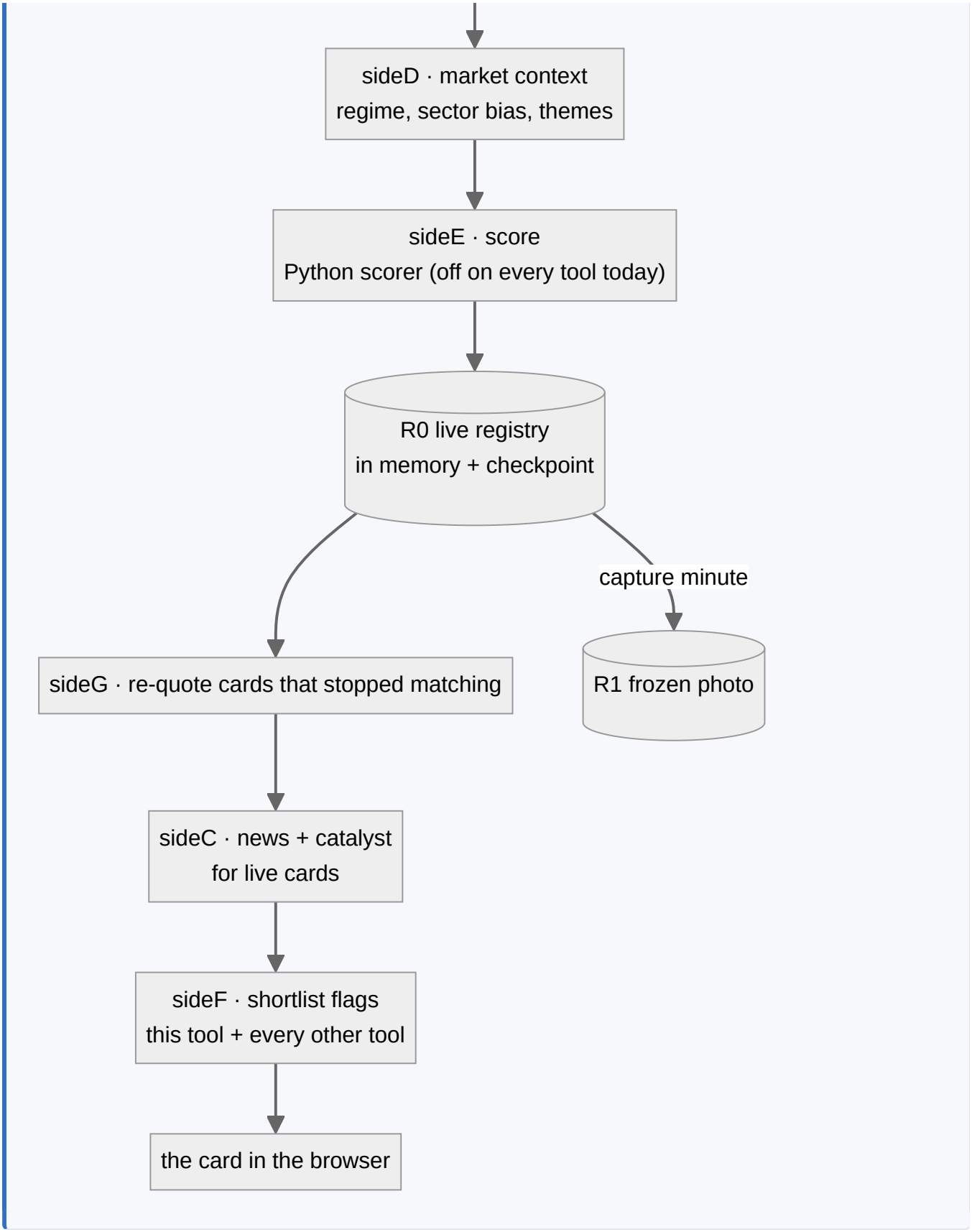
REGISTERS.md	every register (R0–R4, Shortlist), when it is written and every column
CARD.md	the card’s layout, section by section, and its display rules
CARD-FIELDS.md	every field on a card, its source, and when a blank is legitimate
MARKET-TAB.md	the Market tab: indexes, O’Neil model, regime, sectors, groups
METHODOLOGY.md	what each tool’s screeners hunt for and why

Everything here happens **inside each tool’s own process** (T1, T2, T6, T7, T11 today). Each tool runs this pipeline against its own screeners and keeps its own results. The only things tools share are files of facts about the market (see *Shared facts* at the end).

---

1. The shape of it


TradingView scanner
one request per due screener
sideA · scan
map 32 columns per row
pre-R0 gate
(T6 only: move rate, no news, 6-month trend)
merge
one row per ticker, screenerKeys[]
sideB · derived numbers
gap, ranges, ADR %, relations
short interest
FINRA → Yahoo → Nasdaq
borrow
Alpaca shortable · Reg SHO lists
CANSLIM row (cs* columns)
from qp
industry map
record the label



Two kinds of run:

Run	When (New York time, weekdays)	What it does
Discovery scan (`runFullScan`)	04:00–09:00 every 30 min · 09:00–10:00 every 5 min · 10:00–16:00 every 15 min · 16:00	All 12 stages below. Only screeners inside their run window are asked.
Refresh (`runRefreshOnly`)	every 5 min, 04:00–16:00	Re-quotes every card already on screen (one batched TradingView call), recomputes derived numbers. No new cards, no news, no re-scoring.

A run is skipped when the tool is paused, or when another run is still going.

---

2. Stage by stage

Each stage is **fatal** (a failure ends the scan and leaves the cards already on screen untouched) or **soft** (a failure is logged in the scan report and the scan carries on without that information).

Stage A — the TradingView scan (fatal)

`src/sideA/tvScanner.js`

- **Endpoint:** `POST https://scanner.tradingview.com/america/scan?label-product=screener-stock` with a browser User-Agent, Origin and Referer of tradingview.com, 15 s timeout.
- **Which screeners:** every enabled screener of this tool whose run window contains the current minute (`screenerStore.isActiveAt`). Each is one request, sent in parallel.
- **Request body:** the screener's own filters **plus the tradability floor** (`tradable.serverFilters`: price ≥ $1, 10-day average volume ≥ 1M, ATR ≥ $1), a base filter (common/preferred stock, depositary receipts and non-ETF funds; no pre-IPO), the screener's sort, and a page of 50 rows (or the screener's own `limit`).
  - The **Unexplained Move** screeners (T6) keep only the price floor.
  - A **label-only** screener (T8's CANSLIM Universe) takes no floor, and its rows never become cards.
- **Columns asked for (32), and the card field each becomes:**

TradingView column	Card field		TradingView column	Card field
`close`	`price`		`High.1M` / `Low.1M`	`monthHigh` / `monthLow`
`open`	`open`		`High.5D` / `Low.5D`	`weekHigh` / `weekLow` (5 trailing sessions)
`change`	`change` (% today)		`High.3M` / `Low.3M`	`quarterHigh` / `quarterLow`
`change_from_open`	`_changeFromOpen`		`price_52_week_high/low`	`yearHigh` / `yearLow`
`relative_volume_intraday|5`	`rvol` (preferred)		`High.All`	`allTimeHigh`
`relative_volume_10d_calc`	`rvol` (fallback when the intraday one is empty or 0)		`high` / `low`	`dayHigh` / `dayLow`
`VWAP`	`vwap`		`ATR`	`atr` (14-day)
`EMA9` `EMA13` `EMA20` `EMA50`	`ema9` … `ema50`		`premarket_high/low`	`pmHigh` / `pmLow`
`SMA5`	`sma5`		`market_cap_basic`	`mcap`
`sector` / `industry`	`sector` / `industry`		`float_shares_outstanding`	`floatShares`
`short_percentage_of_float`	`shortFloat` (TradingView never fills it — see short interest)		`ticker-view` + the row's symbol	`ticker`, `tvSymbol` (e.g. `NASDAQ:AAPL`)

- **Safety checks on every answer:**
  - **Column alignment (D-S3):** if the row length differs from the 32 columns asked for, the whole batch is refused rather than shifting every field by one.
  - **Range sanity:** a warning when two range windows come back identical for most rows.
  - **ATR % floor, locally:** rows whose ATR is under 3 % of price are dropped (`tradable.applyLocal`). TradingView cannot compare two columns, so this leg runs here. A missing ATR is kept, not dropped.
- **Output:** `candidates` = `{ screenerName: [rows] }`; label-only screeners go to a separate `labels` pile.

The pre-R0 gate — T6 only (inside stage A)

`src/sideA/preR0.js` — applies only to the `unexplained-move` and `unexplained-move-mirror` screeners. Three tests, in this order, before anything reaches the registry:

Test	Data	Rule
Move rate	Alpaca 1-minute bars for today (`fetchIntradayBars`)	≥ +15 % (mirror: ≤ −15 %) over the **last 120 minutes**, measured close to close. No full 120-minute window = dropped.
No news	`fetchNewsForTicker` (the full news stack, below)	any catalyst = dropped. A failed lookup = dropped.
Six-month trend	Alpaca daily closes **before today** (`fetchClosesBefore`), 126 sessions	base: dropped if the six months rose more than 20 %; mirror: dropped if they fell more than 20 %. Under 126 sessions = dropped.

Survivors carry `move2hPct` and `trend6mPct` onto their card. Every drop is counted with its reason in the scan report. If the gate itself throws, the candidates pass through untouched (an empty scan would look like a quiet market).

Merge

`src/sideA/merge.js` — one row per ticker across every screener of the tool. `screenerKeys` lists every screener that matched it this scan. Where two screeners returned the same ticker, a field empty in the first is filled from the second; a value is never overwritten.

Stage B — derived numbers (fatal)

`src/sideB/calculations.js` and `relations.js`. Pure arithmetic on the fields above; a missing input gives a missing output, never a zero (F-14).

Field	Formula
`prevClose`	`price / (1 + change/100)`
`gapPct`	`(open − prevClose) / prevClose × 100`
`pmRange`	`pmHigh − pmLow`
`adrPct`	`atr / price × 100`
`pmAdrRatio`	`pmRange / atr` (0 when ATR is 0)
`weekRangePos`, `monthRangePos`, `quarterRangePos`, `yearRangePos`	`(price − low) / (high − low) × 100`
`dist<Level>` for EMA 9/13/20/50, SMA 5, VWAP, prev close, open, PM high, PM low	`(price − level) /
`vs<Level>`	`above` / `below` (sign of the distance)
`aboveAllMas` / `belowAllMas`	all four EMAs known and all above / all below
`maStack`, `maStackScore`	count of EMA9>13, 13>20, 20>50: 3 = `bull`, 0 = `bear`, else `mixed`
`monthQuarter`	month-range position: <25 `Q1`, <50 `Q2`, <75 `Q3`, else `Q4`
`pmAdrBand`	PM/ADR ratio: `<0.5`, `0.5-1`, `1-2`, `2-3`, `3+`
`dayRangePos`	`(price − dayLow) / (dayHigh − dayLow) × 100`

The relation fields live in `row.signals`; the rest in `row.stock`.

Short interest (soft)

`src/sideC/shortInterest.js` — only for cards with no `shortFloat` yet. TradingView's column is always empty, so three sources are tried in order:

1. **FINRA's own file**: `cdn.finra.org/equity/regsho/monthly/shrt{date}.txt`, then the OTC biweekly paths. One file covers every symbol and is cached for the day. It gives shares short, and the percentage uses the card's float.
2. **Yahoo** `quoteSummary` (per symbol; cookie and crumb from `fc.yahoo.com`).
3. **Nasdaq** `api.nasdaq.com/api/quote/{t}/short-interest` (per symbol, with two weeks of history).

Writes `shortFloat`, `shortBasis` (`float`, or `outstanding` when no float is known, which understates it), `shortAsOf`, `shortSrc`, `shortTrend` and `daysToCover`. A success is cached per ticker for the day; a failure is not.

Borrow (soft)

`src/sideC/borrow.js` — two different questions, never merged:

Field	Source	Meaning
`shortable`, `easyToBorrow`, `borrowNote`	Alpaca assets API (paper endpoint unless `APCA_API_BASE_URL` says otherwise), per symbol, cached	will the broker let you short it now
`regSho`, `regShoDay`, `regShoNote`	Nasdaq `nasdaqth{yyyymmdd}.txt` + NYSE threshold-securities download, for the settlement day	is it on the Reg SHO threshold list (a symptom of hard borrow)

Every value is true, false or null. Null means the question could not be asked; it never means "no".

CANSLIM row (soft)

`src/sideA/canslimRow.js` — puts the O'Neil reading on the row, so it is frozen into R1. It reads the same sources the card's CANSLIM section reads, all from **qp** over localhost (`QP_URL`, default `127.0.0.1:8765`) and its shared files:

qp source	Columns
`/api/oneil/fundamentals` (EDGAR, cached only)	`csEpsChg`, `csSalesChg`, `csQuarter`, `csAccelerating`, `csBeats`, `csGrowth3yr`, `csStability`, `csRoe`
`/api/oneil/base` (weekly bars)	`csBaseWeeks`, `csBaseDepth`, `csPivot`, `csPctToPivot`, `csBaseScore`, `csHandle`
`/api/oneil/ratings`	`csUdRatio`, `csAdLetter`, `csRsLineTell`
`data/oneil-groups.json`	`csGroup`, `csGroupLevel`, `csGroupRank`, `csGroupOf`, `csRsInGroup`, `csGroupMembers`
`/api/oneil/13f`	`csFunds`, `csFundsChg`, `csFundsDir`
`data/oneil-market.json` + `/api/oneil/stock`	`csMarket`, `csDdChecked`, `csDdHeld`, `csDdAvgRel`, `csDdVerdict`

Each value is null when its source has nothing. A failed source never fails the scan.

Asked once a day per ticker. Each tool keeps qp's answers in its own memory for the New York day (`src/sideD/oneil.js`) and asks only for tickers it has not had an answer for, in batches (50 symbols for distribution days, 25 for ratings, 20 for bases). EDGAR's C and A values are read **from qp's cache only** (batches of 40): a ticker the nightly walk has not reached reads "not fetched yet", and when a page shows its card the tool queues it for a background fetch, one name at a time, at most once a day. The card's CANSLIM section reads the same caches through the tool's `/api/market/oneil/*` routes. A failed ask is not cached, so a ticker first seen while qp is

down stays blank until a later scan retries; a photo taken in that gap freezes the blanks. A tool restart starts the caches empty, and five tools ask for the same tickers separately.

Industry map (soft)

`src/sideA/industryMap.js` — records each row's TradingView sector and industry into `data/industry-map.json`, **only for symbols the nightly SIC pass has not classified** (F-21: SIC wins). qp ranks industry groups from this map.

Stage D — market context (soft)

`src/sideD/engine.js` — builds the market snapshot once per scan, then stamps every row's `context`. Full detail in MARKET-TAB.md.

- **Data:** TradingView scanner again: SPY, QQQ, IWM, DIA, VIX and 15 sector ETFs, with columns close, change, change|1W, SMA5/20/50/200, Bollinger upper/lower, ADX, VWAP, relative volume.
- **Stamped on each row:** `regime`, `regimeLabel`, `longTerm`, `midTerm`, `shortTerm`, `broadResolved` (the row's TradingView sector mapped to one of the 15 sector ETFs), `secBias`, `secScore`, `secHot`, and `themes` (from a ticker list and an industry list in `sideD/themes.js`).
- If SPY **and** QQQ are both incomplete, there is **no regime this scan**: the rows keep no context rather than a made-up bearish one (D-S2).

Stage E — score (soft)

`src/sideE/score.js` — sends each row's features to the tool's Python scorer (`SCORER_URL`). Every tool runs with the scorer **off by configuration** today (the deploy prints `scorer: off (by config)`), so `_score` is null on every card. See *D-D1* in KNOWN-ISSUES.md. A manual long/short bias and an already-known catalyst are carried into the score request.

Into R0

Every existing card is marked not-live, then the scan's rows are upserted into the **live registry** (`src/r0/registry.js`). A new ticker gets an id, `firstSeen`, `bias: auto`. An existing one keeps its id, `firstSeen`, its shortlist star and the earliest time each screener matched it (`seenAt`), and takes the scan's new numbers. A card that stopped matching stays on screen, marked **Stale**.

Stage G — re-quote stale cards (soft)

`src/sideG/staleFetch.js` — cards no longer returned by any screener are re-quoted by symbol (batches of 200, the same 32 columns), so their price and levels keep moving. Enriched fields that the plain quote does not carry (short interest, borrow, move rate, trend) are carried over.

Stage C — news and catalyst (soft)

`src/sideC/news.js` and `technical.js` — for every **live** card.

- **Sources, in parallel:**

Source	Endpoint	Needs
TradingView news	`news-headlines.tradingview.com/v2/headlines`	nothing
Alpaca (Benzinga)	`data.alpaca.markets/v1beta1/news`	Alpaca key
Yahoo	`query1.finance.yahoo.com/v1/finance/search`	nothing
SEC EDGAR full-text search	`efts.sec.gov/LATEST/search-index`	a User-Agent
Finnhub	`finnhub.io/api/v1/company-news`	Finnhub key
Google News RSS	`news.google.com/rss/search`	only asked when the five above returned fewer than 2 items

- **Filtering:**
  - stories older than **21 days** are not shown;
  - market round-ups (lists of movers, more than 8 related symbols) are dropped;
  - law-firm class-action notices never count as catalysts;
  - the same headline from several sources is kept once, with its earliest time.
- **Catalyst:** each headline from the last **7 days** is matched against 39 categories in three tiers:
  - **tier 1:** FDA approval or rejection, trial result, earnings beat or miss, guidance, M&A target, offering, bankruptcy, short report;
  - **tier 2:** upgrade, downgrade, contract, partnership, buyback, splits, index changes, listing status, legal risk;
  - **tier 3:** insider trades, product, management, restructuring.

  The score is the tier base (100 / 60 / 30), plus 8 per corroborating headline (up to 3), plus a recency adjustment (+15 under a day, +5 under two, −10 under four, −25 older). The best score is the catalyst, and the rest are kept as `others`.
- **Technical catalysts** (the tape, not a story), from the card's own numbers:
  - Gap Up/Down: |gap| ≥ 4 % on ≥ 2.5× volume.
  - Big Move: |change| ≥ 2× ADR % and ≥ 5 %, on ≥ 2× volume.
  - Volume Surge: ≥ 5× volume with |change| ≥ 2 %.
  - Monthly Breakout/Breakdown: through the 1-month high or low on ≥ 2× volume.
  - Squeeze Setup: short float ≥ 20 %, up ≥ 3 %, on ≥ 3× volume.

  A technical catalyst leads only when there is no fresh news, and it never sets bias.
- **Auto bias** (`sideC/bias.js`):
  - a manual long/short always wins;

    - else a fresh, non-technical tier-1 bull or bear catalyst decides;
    - a tier-2 one decides unless both the short-term market and the sector oppose it;
    - else the market and sector context decide;
    - else “no read”.
- Written to the row as `news` (each source’s items and status, `agedOut`, `fetchedAt`), `catalyst` and `autoBias`.

Stage F — shortlist flags (soft)

`src/sideF` — marks `inShortlist` from this tool’s shortlist, and `shortlistedBy` / `shortlistedElsewhere` from the unified list every tool publishes (`data/shortlist-all.json`).

After the scan

- The whole registry is written to `r0_checkpoint` (one row in the tool’s database). On restart the tool reloads it when it is from the same day, so a deploy does not empty the screen for the rest of the day.
- At midnight the registry is cleared. A scan that finds yesterday’s rows also clears it.

---

3. The refresh (every 5 minutes)

`runRefreshOnly` → `staleFetch.refreshAllInR0`:

- re-quotes **every** card of today by symbol;
- recomputes the derived numbers and relations;
- carries the enriched fields over.

The score a card got at discovery is not recomputed. If TradingView answers with misaligned columns, that batch is refused.

---

4. Where each kind of information comes from

Information	Source	When
Candidates, prices, levels, ranges, volume, float, cap, sector	TradingView scanner	every scan and refresh
Derived numbers and relations	computed	every scan and refresh
Move rate, six-month trend (T6)	Alpaca bars	each T6 scan
Short interest, days to cover	FINRA file → Yahoo → Nasdaq	once per ticker per day
Shortable	Alpaca	once per ticker per process
Reg SHO threshold	Nasdaq and NYSE daily files	once per settlement day
CANSLIM letters	qp (EDGAR, bars, 13F, market model, groups)	every scan, from qp's caches
Market regime, sector bias, themes	TradingView (indexes, sector ETFs), computed	every scan
News, catalyst, auto bias	5 news sources + Google fallback	every scan, live cards
Score	Python scorer	every scan (off today)
Outcomes (R3)	Yahoo bars → Alpaca bars	16:05

5. Shared facts, and who writes them

File	Written by	Read by
`data/industry-map.json`	qp's nightly SIC pass (wins); each tool for unclassified symbols	qp's group ranks
`data/oneil-market.json`	qp	every tool (CANSLIM M, R2)
`data/oneil-groups.json`	qp	every tool (CANSLIM L, Market tab)
`data/oneil-13f.json`	qp	every tool (CANSLIM I)
`data/shortlist-all.json`	every tool, its own section	every tool (`★ also` badge)

Each one is a **label, never a filter**: no tool’s candidates change because of what is in these files.